

Otto von Guericke University Magdeburg

Faculty of Computer Science

Knowledge Management & Discovery Lab

Exercise 10

1. Silhouette coefficient.

Given are 8 two-dimensional points with coordinates shown in Table 1. The clustering result is:

$$G_1 = \{s_1, s_2\}, \quad G_2 = \{s_3, s_4, s_5\}, \quad G_3 = \{s_6, s_7, s_8\}.$$

Calculate the silhouette coefficient for the cluster **G2**. Use Euclidean distance as the distance measure.

Table 1: Point coordinates for the silhouette coefficient task.

ID	s_1	s_2	s_3	s_4	s_5	s_6	s_7	s_8
x	1	2	5	6	8	5	7	8
y	1	3	5	6	4	1	2	1

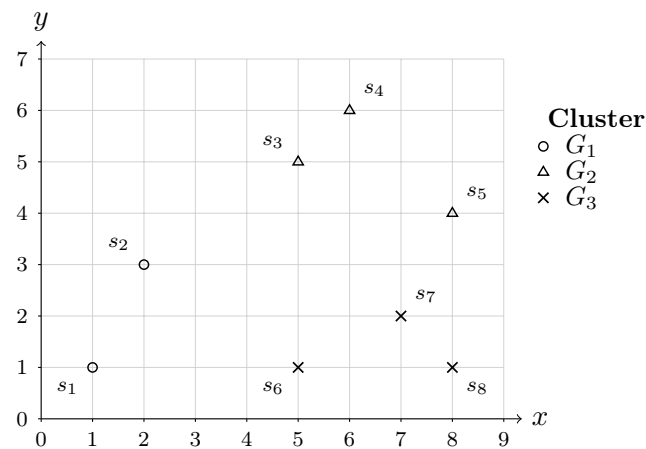


Figure 1: Clustering result for the silhouette coefficient task.

2. Describe the purpose of the feature selection process:

- Why is feature selection done, and what is its goal?
- Which selection methods were presented in the lecture?
- At what point do the presented methods select the final set of features, and to which of the three categories of search methods presented in the lecture do they belong?

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3. The quality of selected feature subsets is analyzed in the lecture, among other things, with regard to inter-feature redundancies. Describe the measure and explain:
 - (a) To which data types can the measure be applied? How might it need to be modified in order to be applicable?
 - (b) In which value range do possible quality values fall? Which value is ideal, and which is catastrophic?
 - (c) Describe how you would use the measure and a set of features to assess whether more features should be removed.
 4. How can the quality of selected feature subsets be assessed with regard to a performance criterion? Describe and explain the measure that was presented in the lecture:
 - (a) To which data types can the measure be applied? How might it need to be modified in order to be applicable?
 - (b) In which value range do possible quality values fall? Which value is ideal, and which is catastrophic?
 - (c) Describe how you would use the measure and a set of features to assess whether more features should be removed.